

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Unstained by Compassion'

Ārya-kāruṇā-anavilā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 698 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྒྱི་རྩེ་མ་བཤལོ་བ་ནས་བརྒྱུན་གྱི་བུ་སྒྱུ་སྒྱུ་

Toh 698 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-kāruṇā-anavilā-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as "Phags pa snying rjes mi bshol ba zhes bya ba'i gzungs," rendered in English as something like "The Noble Dhāraṇī Undefined by Compassion." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a sacred incantation associated with the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the embodiment of compassion, whose recitation is said to liberate beings from harm, illness, malevolent spirits, and the eight states of unfortunate rebirth. The text opens with homages to the Three Jewels, to vast numbers of fully awakened buddhas, and to Avalokiteśvara himself before introducing the dhāraṇī as spoken by that noble bodhisattva and intended for the protection and welfare of all beings.

In the language of India: Ārya-kāruṇā-anavilā-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Noble One Unstained by Compassion" — that is, the dhāraṇī of the noble Avalokiteśvara known as "Undefined by Great Compassion."

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the seventy million perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. Homage to the great bodhisattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, lord of great compassion, who liberates completely from all harm, who pacifies completely all illness, who turns back without exception all spirits, and who perfectly rescues beings who have fallen into the eight states of unfortunate birth.

Having paid homage to him, recite this dhāraṇī of great compassion that is without defilement, as spoken by the noble Avalokiteśvara — and with this recitation, supplicate the lord of great compassion to regard you with care. Regard me with care, regard me with care.

Tadyathā. Oṃ jaṭa jaṭa, jiṭi jiṭi, juṭu juṭu, tara tara, tiri tiri, turu turu, kala kala, kili kili, kulu kulu.

O lord of great compassion, you who are the great assembly of all Tathāgatas — thinking upon us with care, please come. Please come. Caṭa caṭa, ciṭi ciṭi, cuṭu cuṭu.

Thinking upon the cloud of aspirations of all bodhisattvas, O lord of great compassion, please come swiftly. Please come swiftly. Rala rala, rili rili, rulu rulu.

Please rise from the ground of meditative concentration, liberation, meditative absorption, and meditative equipoise. Please rise. Cala cala, cili cili, culu culu. Bodhi bodhi. Ehi ehi. Buddha buddha.

By the truth of the Buddha, by the truth of the Dharma, by the truth of the Saṅgha — please arise. Please arise. Through great loving-kindness, please turn back all spirits. Through the cloud of great compassion, please pacify completely all my illness.

Dhuna dhuna, bidhuna bidhuna, mathā mathā, pramatha pramatha. Please arise. Please arise. Come here, come here. Please fulfill my wishes. Please purify my karma.

Mahā-kāruṇikāya svāhā. Mahā-padma-hastāya svāhā. Padmāsanāya svāhā. Śvetajñā-upavītaya svāhā. Kiriṭane svāhā. Śūlane svāhā. Cakrāne svāhā. Vajrāne svāhā. Trinetraya prahaṃ-rūpāya svāhā. Ākāśāya svāhā. Śīni śīni svāhā. Pracavataye svāhā. Yamaye svāhā. Yamabhūdyaya svāhā. Āṇḍaje bhūtebhyaḥ svāhā. Jarāyuje bhūtebhyaḥ svāhā. Saṃsvedaje bhūtebhyaḥ svāhā. Aupapāduke bhūtebhyaḥ svāhā. Viṭikabhyo bhyadhībhyaḥ svāhā. Vaidhitakebhyo bhyadhībhyaḥ svāhā. Śleṣmakebhyo bhyadhībhyaḥ svāhā. Sannipatikebhyo bhyadhībhyaḥ svāhā. Sarvabuddho svāhā. Sarvabhyatibhyaḥ svāhā. Bhūme anantarīcaryebhyaḥ svāhā.

Tadyathā. Oṃ traṭa traṭa, triṭi triṭi, truṭu truṭu. Protect me, protect me from all fears, all harms, and all illness. Svāhā. Grasa grasa, matha matha, pramatha pramatha, hana hana, daha daha, paca paca. Namas ārya-avalokiteśvara-ājñāpayati svāhā.

The noble Avalokiteśvara, lord of great compassion, the heart

Translator's Notes

- The title rendered as "Unstained by Compassion" or "Undeiled by Great Compassion" reflects the Sanskrit Ārya-kāruṇā-anavilā, where anavilā means "undeiled" or "unstained." The Tibetan snyin rjes mi bshol ba is a slight paraphrase conveying the same sense of compassion that is pure and unsullied.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text itself is truncated. The final line breaks off at "the heart" and continues on a subsequent folio not supplied here.

The lists of beings beginning with āṇḍaja, jarāyuja, saṃsvedaja, and aupapāduka refer to the four modes of birth: egg-born, womb-born, moisture-born, and spontaneously-born beings respectively. The subsequent terms — viṭika, vaidhitaka, śleṣmaka, and sannipatika — refer to categories of disease in classical Indian medical theory: wind-disorders, bile-disorders, phlegm-disorders, and combined-humour disorders. These are preserved as Sanskrit in the dhāraṇī body and glossed here for clarity.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.